VIETNAMESE RICE PAPER ROLLS
With Peanut sauce

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*Packed with bright, fresh assorted ingredients. They are served with an insanely delicious peanut dipping sauce. Also known as **gỏi cuốn** /summer rolls. They are fresh, light, and healthy Vietnamese appetizer or snack. They consist of assorted fresh, savory ingredients.*

Origin

Rice paper rolls (gỏi cuốn), originating from South Vietnam, are a staple dish born from local agricultural traditions, characterized by fresh herbs, protein (tofu, pork, shrimp), and vermicelli wrapped in thin, edible rice paper (bánh tráng). Known as "salad rolls" in the South and "nem cuốn" in the North, they represent a healthy, fresh, and non-fried alternative to traditional fried spring rolls.

At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 20 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 30 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

Preparation – *Mis en place –Everything in its place*

Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.

- **Soak/Activate: Marinate tofu in soy sauce, ponzu, garlic and red pepper flakes**
- **Soak/ Activate: Place rice noodles in boiling water until soften**
- **Chop/Dice: Lettuce, Tofu, carrots, cucumbers, avocado**
- **Assemble Tools: griddle**

Ingredients

Primary Plant Protein/Base:

- Extra firm tofu – 2 packages

Fresh Produce & Aromatics:

- butter lettuce - 8 sheets
- 6 persian cucumbers – Julien
- 2 large carrots – Julien or shredded
- 2 avocados – sliced thin
- mint
- **Pantry Staples & Seasonings:**
- 3 garlic cloves finely chopped
- 1 tsp red pepper flakes
- 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tbsp ponzu
- Rice paper
- Rice noodles
- **Garnishes/Toppings:** sesame seeds

Directions

Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"

1. **Prepare**
    1. Tofu –Slice tofu and marinate in soy sauce, ponzu and chopped garlic
    2. Vegetables – cut each and place each type on a plate
    3. Rice noodles- place in a bowl with boiling water to soften (about 5-8 mins)
2. **Pre- cook**
    1. Place tofu on the griddle (or can air fry)– lightly sauté on both sides. When complete, put on a plate to cool
    2. Soften noodles
3. **Ready to form rolls – have all ingredients in front of you.**

1. Hold rice paper and quickly place under water
2. Place on a plate and massage
3. Add ingredients one at a time

   We will be making 2 different versions

   - "Authentic Gui-cuon" - lettuce, tofu, bean sprouts, rice noodles, carrots, mint. Add sesame seeds to the top (fold like a square).

     Tip - Wrap the tofu, bean sprouts and vermicelli noodles, and mint in the lettuce then roll it up and/or scrunch it lightly so it stays together. Then roll it up in the rice paper. Much easier to handle!

   - My "summer rolls" - one with tofu, avocado, carrots, cucumbers – (folded like an eggroll)

4. **Fold and roll into rice paper – *tightly***

   - Form Summer rolls and Gui-cuon like an eggroll – folding sides in first and then roll to the end. You can also make like a square.

5. **Griddle to crisp**

   - Put some of them on the griddle – for these add some sesame seeds- turn on both sides until crispy.

Quick Tips

Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.

- **Flavor Boost:** add mint
- **Substitution:** add different versions of ingredients. You can use firm tofu – but make sure you take out all the water before cooking. You can also add other cooked proteins i.e. shrimp, chicken, pork)
- **Meal Prep Hack:** Don't make ahead of dinner. Prepare and then immediately serve. The summer rolls don't last long in the refrigerator – you can put a wet paper towel on the top to maintain better.

PEANUT SAUCE

- 1 tbsp peanut butter, preferably smooth (crunchy is ok too)
- 2 tbsp Hoisin Sauce
- 1/2 tbsp vinegar or lime juice
- 1/3 cup water
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- 1/2 tsp crushed chili flakes

Alternative recipe – less authentic but still yummy

- ½ cup smooth peanut butter
- 1 tbsp sugar
- 4 tbsp hoisin sauce
- 1 tbsp sweet soy sauce (kecap manis, it's thick like syrup)
- 2 small garlic cloves (or 1 large), minced
- 1 birds eye chili, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp sesame oil
- 2 tbsp lime juice
- Water

Combine the Peanut Dipping Sauce ingredients. Mix briefly (it won't come together immediately), then microwave for 30 seconds. Mix again until smooth. Set aside to cool. Adjust sour with vinegar, salt with salt and spiciness to taste. Thickness can be adjusted with milk or water once cooled.

Nutritional Information

Estimated values

Tofu -Firm	90-144 calories per 100g, 10-14 g protein, 7 g fiber, 2g low carbs, Fat - hearthealthy polyunsaturated fat, 0 cholesterol. Includes calcium, manganese, iron, copper, selenium, phosphorus, magnesium, zinc and vitamins A, B1, B2 and B5
Carrots	25 calories per carrot, exceptional vitamin A Carbohydrates: 9.0–9.6 g (including ~3–5 g of natural sugars). Fiber: 2.7–3.0 g. Protein: 0.8–1.0 g Fat: <0.3 g Carrots are a "superfood" for micronutrients, particularly vitamins A, K1, potassium, B7 and B6
Cucumbers	28 calories (per 100 g), 2 grams of fiber, 1 gram of protein and very low fat Has nutrient-dense vegetables packed with vitamins (especially C, A, B6, K, E) and minerals (potassium, folate), providing antioxidants and fiber for digestive health
Avocado	160 calories (per 100g), 2 g protein, 7 g fiber, 8.5 g Carbs, 15g healthy fats (most are monosaturated fat) Includes 20 different vitamins and minerals, notably: Potassium, Vitamins K, B9, C, E, and B6, magnesium & copper
Lettuce	17 calories per 100g, 2 grams Fiber,1 gram protein, 3 g carbs, very little fat. Dense in micronutrients including vitamin K, A, C, B9, and potassium
Rice Noodles	100 calories (per 100g), 1 g fiber, 2 gr protein, 24 g carbs, very low fat and sodium. Refined from rice flour, rice noodles are considered a high-energy carb and are digested very quickly. Gluten-Free A good source of selenium and provide a modest amount of manganese and phosphorus
Peanut Butter	188 calories 2 tbs. 7 g protein, 16 g fat, 7 g carbs, 2g fiber, 3 g sugar Nutrient dense - Peanut butter is a good source of protein, monounsaturated fats, fiber, and many vitamins and minerals like phosphorus, potassium, and niacin. The high-fat content promotes satiety and satisfaction with meals," she says. This also makes peanut butter great for someone trying to lose weight, because the fat and protein content will keep you full for longer

What is tofu and is it good for you?

Tofu is a nutrient-dense, plant-based protein made from curdled soy milk pressed into blocks, offering a complete amino acid profile, high iron, and calcium. It is generally considered very healthy, supporting heart health, reducing risk of certain cancers, and aiding weight management. It is low-fat, cholesterol-free, and safe for daily consumption.

It is a nutrient-dense, plant-based complete protein containing all nine essential amino acids required by the body. Its nutritional profile varies primarily by its firmness; firmer varieties generally contain more protein, fat, and calories per serving because they have less water content.

- **Extra-Firm Tofu:** provides 15-17 g of protein, and 145 calories
- **Firm Tofu:** provides 8–10g of protein and 70-80 calories
- **Silken/Soft Tofu:** Higher in water content, providing about 4–7g of protein and 40–62 calories

Key Health Benefits

- **Heart Health:** Tofu is cholesterol-free, low in saturated fat, and may help reduce LDL cholesterol. Studies show eating at least one serving per week may lower heart disease risk by 18%.
- **Nutrient-Rich:** It is a good source of iron, manganese, selenium, phosphorus, and calcium, especially when made with calcium-sulfate.
- **Cancer Risk Reduction:** Tofu contains isoflavones, which have antioxidants, anti-inflammatory, and potential protective effects against breast, prostate, and colorectal cancers.
- **Bone Health:** The high calcium and magnesium content helps prevent osteoporosis.